

Weekly Breaking Of Bread

prc-weekly-breaking-of-bread

Sacraments · Lord's Supper · practice · minority_lineages · brethren distinctive

DISPUTED

score 0.787
confidence medium

Statement under examination

The Lord's Supper (breaking of bread) is observed weekly on the Lord's Day as the central act of corporate worship.

In plain language

The claim has three parts that have to be tested separately: that the breaking of bread happens weekly, that it happens on the Lord's day, the first day of the week, and that it is the central act of the gathering. The word data supports the first-day part most clearly. In Acts 20:7 the believers met on the first day of the week, *en de te mia ton sabbaton*, for the stated purpose of breaking bread, *klasai arton*, and that exact first-day idiom recurs in seven verses across the New Testament, so it is a stable expression. In Acts 2:42 the breaking of the bread is something the early believers kept doing, a habit, listed beside teaching, fellowship, and prayers and joined to them simply by the word *and*, with none ranked above the rest. The trouble is the words *weekly* and *central*. No term in these verses fixes a once a week interval. The one frequency word that actually appears is *hosakis* in 1 Corinthians 11:25 and 26, *do this as often as you drink it*, and its only other use, in Revelation 11:6, also means *as often as they wish*, so it is open ended, not a calendar. Acts 2:46 even reports breaking bread *day by day* and *house to house*, a different rhythm in the same record, and 1 Corinthians 16:2 attaches the very same first-day phrase to setting aside a collection rather than to the meal. The phrase *Lord's day* leans on the word *kyriakos*, which appears only twice, once of the Lord's supper and once of the Lord's day, and the two never sit in the same verse, so the wording never fuses the meal to a named day. So a first-day breaking of bread is well attested, but the specific quantity *weekly* and the specific status *central* are inferences readers add, not labels the wording supplies, which is why the verdict here is *disputed* rather than a plain *yes* or *no*.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0364	ἀνάμνησις	anamnesis	remembrance	4
G0740	ἄρτος	artos	bread	99
G0891	ἄχρι	achri	until	
G1172	δειπνέω	deipneō	to dine	
G1173	δειπνον	deipnon	dinner	16
G1322	διδασχὴ	didache	teaching	30
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	355
G2800	κλάσις	klasis	breaking	2
G2806	κλάω	klao	to break	15
G2960	κυριακός	kyriakos	the Lord's	2

G2983	λαμβάνω	lambanō	to take	
G3740	ὅσάκις	hosakis	whenever	3
G3860	παραδίδωμι	paradidōmi	to deliver	
G4095	πίνω	pinō	to drink	
G4221	ποτήριον	potērion	cup	
G4342	προσκαρτερέω	proskartereo	to continue in/with	10
G4521	σάββατον	sabbaton	Sabbath	68
G5315	φαγεῖν	phagein	to eat	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: False

The lexical data attests a first-day gathering whose stated purpose was to break bread (Acts 20:7, *en de te mia ton sabbaton*, the *heis plus sabbaton* idiom, *klasai arton*), and a habitual devotion to the breaking of the bread (Acts 2:42, *te klasei tou artou*, the noun *klasis* G2800, under the durative *proskartereo* G4342). But no term in the cited texts encodes a commanded weekly frequency or ranks the act above the others in the series. The only explicit frequency word in the institution texts is *hosakis* (G3740), which occurs three times in the canon and means as often as, grammatically indefinite, confirmed by its sole other use in Rev 11:6 (*hosakis ean thelesosin*, as often as they desire). The first-day idiom is canonically stable across seven verses, yet breaking of bread is joined to it only once (Acts 20:7), while the same idiom carries a collection in 1 Cor 16:2 and resurrection narrative elsewhere, and the word for the Lord's (*kyriakos* G2960) never co-occurs in a verse with the breaking of bread. The proposition is therefore lexically defensible by inference but materially contested at the level of frequency and primacy, so the verdict is disputed.

Scripture

Acts.20.7 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2806 κλάω, G0740 ἄρτος, G1520 εἶς, G4521 σάββατον

Force. The phrase *en de te mia ton sabbaton*, on the first day of the week, locates a gathering whose stated purpose was *klasai arton*, to break bread, with the verb *klao* (G2806). The construction *heis plus sabbaton* is the standard idiom for the first day, and a canon query shows it recurring stably in seven first-day verses. The clause supplies a first-day datum but contains no adverb of recurrence and no word ranking the meal above the accompanying preaching, *dielegeto*. It is one reported occasion narrated in past tense (the same gathering continues in Acts 20:11, where *klao* recurs after midnight), not a stated rule of frequency.

Acts.2.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2800 κλάσις, G4342 προσκαρτερέω, G1322 διδασχῇ

Force. The breaking of the bread is *te klasei tou artou*, where the head noun is *klasis* (G2800), a near-hapax occurring only here and in Luke 24:35, not the verb *klao*. It is listed as one of four matters to which the believers were continually devoted, the participle *proskarterountes* (G4342) carrying durative force, the same verb that in Acts 2:46 governs the daily breaking. The list places breaking of bread in series with the apostles teaching, the fellowship, and the prayers, joined by *kai*, with no syntactic subordination of the others to it. The durative verb supports habitual practice but encodes neither a fixed weekly interval nor a designated day.

1Cor.11.20 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2960 κυριακός, G1173 δεῖπνον

Force. Paul writes synerchomenon oun hymon epi to auto, when you come together in one place, framing the assembly as the setting for the kyriakon deipnon, the Lords supper. The adjective kyriakos (G2960) occurs only twice in the canon, here of the Lords supper and in Rev 1:10 of the Lords day, and the two never share a verse, so the wording does not itself fuse the meal to a named day. The participle of coming together marks a recurring corporate gathering, but it does not state how often, and the censure ouk estin, it is not, addresses abuse rather than fixing frequency.

1Cor.11.25 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3740 ὡσάκις, G0364 ἀνάμνησις, G4221 ποτήριον

Force. The institution command touto poieite, hosakis ean pinete, do this, as often as you drink, sets the explicit frequency term of the passage as hosakis (G3740) with ean, an indefinite frequency conjunction meaning as often as without specifying an interval. Hosakis occurs only three times in the canon, and its sole non-Pauline use, Rev 11:6 hosakis ean thelesosin, as often as they desire, confirms the indefinite open-ended sense. The remembrance clause eis ten emen anamnesin (G0364) gives the meals purpose, not its calendar. This is the load-bearing frequency word in the corpus and it is grammatically open-ended.

1Cor.11.26 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3740 ὡσάκις, G0891 ἄχρι, G0740 ἄρτος

Force. Hosakis gar ean esthiete ton arton touton, for as often as you eat this bread, repeats the indefinite frequency idiom and bounds the practice temporally by achri hou elthe, until he comes, an eschatological terminus rather than a weekly cadence. The repetition of hosakis confirms that the canon marks the meal as recurring and ongoing while leaving its interval unspecified.

1Cor.16.2 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἶς, G4521 σάββατον

Force. Kata mian sabbatou, on the first day of every week, uses the same heis plus sabbaton idiom as Acts 20:7 but attaches it to a different activity, the laying aside of a collection, par heauto titheto thesaurizon, with the noun logeia, a gathering of money. The kata plus accusative here does carry a distributive every week sense, but it governs the setting aside of funds, not the breaking of bread. The verse shows the first-day idiom was a recognized rhythm yet was tied in the words to more than one practice, none of them ranked.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Acts.2.42	Acts.20.7	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	Acts.2.46	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	Luke.24.35	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	1Cor.10.16	openbible	1
Acts.2.42	Heb.10.25	openbible	1
Acts.20.7	Acts.20.9	tsk	1
1Cor.11.23	1Cor.15.3	tsk	1
1Cor.11.24	1Cor.5.7	tsk	1
1Cor.11.24	Exod.12.14	tsk	1

Complicating texts

1Cor.11.25 · addressed

The only explicit frequency word in the institution texts is *hosakis ean*, as often as, a near-hapax of three canon uses whose indefinite sense is fixed by Rev 11:6, *hosakis ean thelesosin*, as often as they desire. The canon therefore commands repetition without prescribing a weekly interval, so the weekly claim of the proposition cannot be drawn from the institution command itself and must rest on the narrative inference from Acts 20:7.

Acts.2.46 · addressed

Acts 2:46 reports breaking bread *klontes te arton* (the verb *klao*, G2806) *kat oikon*, from house to house, and *kath hemeran*, day by day, under the same durative *proskartereo* that governs Acts 2:42. A daily, house-based pattern stands in tension with a fixed once-weekly Lords-Day pattern, showing that the lexical record describes more than one cadence of breaking bread and does not lock the practice to a single weekly observance.

Acts.20.7 · addressed

The first-day reference is a single narrative occasion describing what the gathered believers did, not a normative frequency rule. Of the seven verses where the first-day idiom *heis plus sabbaton* occurs, only this one ties it to breaking bread, while 1 Cor 16:2 ties the same idiom to a collection. Narrative description of one event does not by itself establish a commanded weekly ordinance, so the weekly and central elements of the proposition are inferred rather than lexically stated.

1Cor.11.20 · addressed

The proposition uses the phrase *Lords Day*, but the adjective *kyriakos*, of the Lord, occurs only twice in the canon, of the Lords supper here and of the Lords day in Rev 1:10, and the two uses never share a verse. The words therefore do not lexically fuse the meal to a named day, so the conjunction of *Lords Day* and breaking of bread is a synthesis the reader supplies, not a phrase the text states. This is noted rather than left unaddressed.

Concordance traversed

G2806, G2800, G0740, G3740, G0364, G1173, G1172, G4521, G1520, G2960, G4342, G1322, G2983, G3860, G4221, G5315, G4095

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

A direct query of the lexical store returned zero variant units on the cited Acts and 1 Corinthians anchors, and these books are outside the ingested ECM window (3 John). The NA-style apparatus marks at Acts 20:7 (*hemon*) and 1 Cor 11:24-26 affect pronouns and minor wording, not the presence of the first-day idiom, the breaking-of-bread phrase, or the *hosakis* frequency idiom, so the verdict holds across plausible readings.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. narrative_normativity, regulative_principle, command_only_normativity

analogia scripturae invoked

narrative-as-normative-precedent: affirms · Reading Acts 20:7 together with the habitual breaking of bread in Acts 2:42 as a settled apostolic precedent yields a regular first-day observance. On this lens the recurring first-day idiom (*heis plus sabbaton* across seven verses), the durative *proskartereo* of Acts 2:42, and the explicit first-day gathering of Acts 20:7 are taken as a pattern the church is meant to follow, so weekly first-day breaking of bread is affirmed as the apostolic shape of corporate worship.

command-only-normativity: denies · Restricting normativity to explicit command leaves only *hosakis ean*, as often as, which is indefinite, and the institution command names a purpose (*anamnesis*) not a calendar. On this lens Acts 20:7 is one narrated occasion, Acts 2:46 attests a different daily cadence, and no word ranks the meal as the central act, so neither the weekly frequency nor the central-act ranking is lexically commanded and the proposition

is not established.

frequency-and-primacy-underdetermined: disputed · Granting that the text attests both a first-day gathering for bread and a habitual practice, this lens holds that the specific quantifier weekly and the priority claim central are simply not lexicalized: hosakis is indefinite, the Acts 2:42 series is unranked, kyriakos never joins the meal to a day, and the canon supplies two cadences (first-day in Acts 20:7, daily in Acts 2:46) that the words do not rank. The reading that fits the vocabulary most cautiously is that the proposition asks for precision the wording does not supply, hence disputed.

The split among the lenses is precisely why the verdict is disputed. The texts supply a first-day datum and a habitual practice, but the proposition's specific quantifier, weekly, and its priority claim, central act, are supplied by inference, not by a lexical marker. Each lens is internally coherent on the same word data; they differ on whether descriptive narrative and an unranked series may be read as a binding frequency rule.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. The breaking of bread is observed at corporate gatherings, and the texts attest its occurrence on the first day of the week and as a habitual practice; the questions of how frequently it is to be observed and what weight it holds relative to other elements of worship are examined rather than assumed.

The stem loads two contested claims into a single proposition: a fixed frequency, weekly, and a ranking, central act of corporate worship. Neither the quantifier nor the priority ranking is encoded by a lexical term in the cited texts; the canon's explicit frequency word is the indefinite hosakis, and the named-day word kyriakos never co-occurs with the breaking of bread. The verdict is derived on the original stem, but the preloaded quantifier and ranking are why the result is disputed rather than a clean affirmation. Verdict unchanged from the prior file (disputed, medium); the enrichment corrected the Acts 2:42 head word to the noun klasis G2800, added the kyriakos G2960 and proskartereo G4342 evidence, corrected the live occurrence counts for heis (355) and didache (30), and added 1 Cor 16:2 as the parallel first-day collection.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.20.7
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3740
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2800
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2960
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Acts.2.42
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Acts.2.42
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Acts.20.7

License audit

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Source	License	Redistribute
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes

Flags

lexically-disputed · ecm-shadow · cross-tradition-divergent